WISE Chapter Resource Guide

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1. Purpose

WISE Connections helps university supply chain students build meaningful relationships. Through campus programming, national events, industry engagement, mentorship, and a national network of peers and professionals, students involved with WISE gain experiences and connections that help them thrive in college and beyond.

2. About WISE

2.1 Mission and Story

Mission: WISE creates opportunities for students to build connections, develop professionally, strengthen leadership skills, and gain industry knowledge that prepares them for impactful careers in supply chain management.

WISE started as a student organization at the University of Arkansas. It has grown into a national network of campus chapters, a student advisory board, and the annual WISE Future Leaders Symposium. The first symposium brought together students and faculty from 12 universities; the 2026 symposium had more than 35 universities.

2.2 The Four WISE Pillars

- **Making Connections:** relationships with peers, alumni, faculty, and industry professionals.
- **Personal and Professional Development:** career skills, confidence, and personal growth.
- **Leadership Skills:** leading with confidence, integrity, and purpose.
- **Supply Chain Industry Knowledge:** understanding how supply chains work and the careers in them.

Plan each semester so that every pillar is covered at least once.

3. Shape

3.1 Universities with WISE Chapters

18 chapters as of June 2026:

University	Social Media
Auburn University	@auburnwise
Colorado State University	@csuwise
Georgia Southern University	LinkedIn: wise-gsu
Indiana University Bloomington	@wise_iu
Iowa State University	@wiseiastate
Miami University	@miamiohwise
Michigan State University	@msuwise
Mississippi State University*	@msu_mwsc
North Carolina A&T State University	@ncatwise
Texas Tech University	@ttuwise
University of Arkansas	@uarkwise
University of Central Florida	@ucfwise
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	@wise.uiuc
University of Kansas	@ku.wise
University of Oklahoma	@ouwise
University of Texas at Dallas	@wise_utd
University of Wisconsin-Madison	@wiseatuw
Western Michigan University	@wmuwise

*Mississippi State's WISE group is a committee inside the Maroon and White Supply Chain club, so it uses the club's Instagram account.

3.2 Interested in Starting a Chapter

Reach out to Dr. Stephanie Thomas, sthomas@walton.uark.edu, so they can help you out with starting one.

3.3 Chapter Structure

Chapters are set up either as a standalone WISE club or as a committee inside a Supply Chain organization. Examples:

3.3.1 Integrated within a Supply Chain / Logistics Club

- Auburn
- Georgia Southern
- Michigan State
- Mississippi State*
- Western Michigan

3.3.2 Standalone Registered WISE Organization

- Colorado State
- Iowa State
- University of Arkansas
- University of Kansas

*Mississippi State has about 10 highly engaged WISE members inside a supply chain club of about 100 students.

3.4 Few Examples for Meeting Frequency

University	Typical Cadence	Duration
Auburn	2-3 events per semester	About 1 hr
Colorado State	2 full chapter programs per semester + socials	About 1 hr
Georgia Southern	2 meetings per month + 1 large event per semester	About 1 hr
Iowa State	4 meetings per semester + 1 flagship panel	About 1.5 hr
Kansas	4 workshops per semester	About 1 hr
Michigan State	1-2 meetings per month	About 1 hr
Mississippi State	Biweekly supply chain club meetings; 1 WISE event per semester	About 1 hr
University of Arkansas	Monthly	About 1.5 hr
Western Michigan	2 meetings per semester + mixer	About 1 hr

3.5 Chapter Size

Small: Auburn, Colorado State, Iowa State, Western Michigan

Medium: Michigan State, University of Kansas

Large: Georgia Southern, University of Arkansas

4. Advice for Planning Impactful Meetings

Use the four WISE pillars to plan a balanced semester.

4.1 Making Connections

Programming ideas:

- Alumni and employer panels with structured networking
- Corporate-hosted mixers (Walmart, International Paper, Belk, McLeod, Supply Chain Gals)
- Speed-networking nights with advisory board members
- Student panels featuring recent graduates
- Mock career fair booths staffed by alumni

Activity ideas:

- Invite-only alumni dinners (5-10 years out)

- Industry hot-topic roundtables
- LinkedIn headshot pop-ups
- Mixers at local restaurants or on-campus lounges

4.2 Personal and Professional Development

Programming ideas:

- Resume and LinkedIn workshops
- Salary negotiation seminars
- Semester kickoff goal-setting sessions
- Leadership conference debriefs
- Personal branding talks
- Internship panel with chapter upperclassmen
- Fireside chats with industry leaders

Activity ideas:

- Dress-for-Success fashion show
- Professional photo sessions
- Time management challenge week
- Productivity tool demonstrations
- Supply Chain Kahoot

4.3 Leadership Skills

Programming ideas:

- "Leading through Influence" workshops
- Cross-campus student leader panels
- Crisis management tabletop exercises
- Leadership case studies

Activity ideas:

- Member-led service projects
- Leadership book clubs
- Personal SWOT analysis with action planning
- Peer mentoring circles

4.4 Supply Chain Industry Knowledge

Programming ideas:

- "Day in the Life" speaker series (logistics, sourcing, planning)
- Technology trend briefings (automation, AI, blockchain)
- Distribution center or warehouse tours
- Case competition preparation sessions

Activity ideas:

- Inventory simulation games
- Virtual reality warehouse tours
- Interactive supply chain mapping exercises
- Data storytelling workshops

4.5 Ideas Borrowed from the Future Leaders Symposium

These sessions from the 2024 and 2025 symposium programs work well as a chapter meeting:

- **Dream Mapping:** members map out their career and personal goals, then share with a partner.
- **Building Your Web of Connections:** a short networking strategy workshop.
- **Vision and Values:** members write down their personal values and what they want from the year.
- **Plan, Source, Make, Deliver rotation:** small groups rotate through stations, one for each part of the supply chain.
- **Hot-topics table discussions:** each table has a discussion leader and one current industry topic.
- **Table chats with young professionals:** recent grads sit at topic tables and students rotate.
- **Themed panels:** "Life Outside the 9 to 5," "Unpacking the Myth of Perfection," and "The Interview Side: Acing It."
- **Reflection close:** end with a table discussion on key takeaways and one personal action item.

4.6 Event Planning Guide and Shared Slides

For step-by-step event planning, use the WISE Event Planning Resource Guide.

For inspiration, browse meeting slides from other WISE chapters in the WISE Resource National Bank (Google Drive). After each meeting, please add your own slides so other chapters can use them.

5. Making Everyone Feel Welcome

5.1 Best Practices (Setup & Logistics)

- Greet attendees at the entrance and dedicate the first five minutes to informal conversation.
- Provide name tents and optional pronoun stickers.
- Rotate seating or breakout groups so members meet new peers.
- Pair newcomers with "WISE buddies" for follow-up check-ins.
- Offer hybrid or recorded options for commuters and interns.

5.2 Ice-Breaker Activity Ideas

- 30-second partner introductions (speed rounds).
- Two Truths and a Lie, supply chain edition.
- "If you could ship any product anywhere, what and where?" quick round.

- Supply Chain Human Bingo focused on internship and travel experiences.

6. Leadership Structure

Examples from current chapters:

Executive Board (6-8 roles)

- President
- VP Programming
- VP Professional Development
- VP Membership
- VP Finance
- Communications Director
- Outreach/Sponsorship
- Events

Co-Presidents + Functional Directors

- Events, Marketing, and Philanthropy directors report to the co-presidents
- Decisions made together with the faculty advisor

Committee-Based / Flat

- Rotating facilitators run meetings
- Volunteer committees (Programming, Outreach, Finance) make decisions by consensus

7. National WISE Resources

7.1 WISE Future Leaders Symposium

The annual national WISE conference, held at the University of Arkansas in Fayetteville. It includes industry panels, workshops, networking, and the WISE Legends recognition, a hall-of-fame style award for women who shaped the supply chain field. Encourage four students from university to attend each fall.

Past programs: 2026 program, 2025 program, 2024 program. The programs are also a good source of speaker and company ideas for chapter events.

7.2 WISE Connections Advisory Board

A board of students from WISE universities that guides WISE's growth nationally. Members meet monthly, help plan the symposium and other events, and work with industry leaders. Applications open each year; watch the newsletter and @wiseconnections on Instagram.

2026 Advisory Board:

Name	Role	University
Dr. Stephanie Thomas	Executive Director of WISE	University of Arkansas
Remington Reaves	Board Chair	University of Arkansas
Hannah Yong	Member	University of Arkansas
Nora Rolison	Member	Michigan State University
Samata Luintel	Member	Mississippi State University
Allie Gonzalez	Member	Western Michigan University
Erin Bath	Member	Colorado State University
Grace Hampton	Member	University of Oklahoma
Morgan Haight	Member	Brigham Young University
Libby Brewer	Member	North Carolina State University
Layla Goudy	Member	North Carolina A&T State University
Rupashi Gupta	Member	Indiana University

Past board chairs: Katherine Thomas (2024) and Sophie Perrigin, Mississippi State (2025).

7.3 WISE Connections Newsletter Archive

WISE sends the WISE Connections email newsletter through Mailchimp, about every two months. It covers WISE events, chapter updates, industry insights, and career development opportunities. Share it with your members and send chapter news to WISE so it can be featured.

Subscribe | Full campaign archive

Date	Issue	Summary
Oct 2026	Symposium 2026 Special Edition	Highlights from the 2026 symposium
Aug 2026	August 2026 Newsletter	Back to school after a busy summer
Jun 2026	June 2026 Newsletter	Summer: challenge yourself
Apr 2026	April 2026 Newsletter	Reset, refocus, and grow
Feb 2026	February 2026 Newsletter	Chapter updates and development opportunities
Dec 2025	December 2025 Newsletter	Year-end updates and highlights
Oct 2025	Symposium 2025 Special Edition	Highlights from the 2025 symposium
Sep 2025	September 2025 Newsletter	Fall updates and new chapter initiatives
Jun 2025	June 2025 Newsletter	Summer highlights and conference info
Apr 2025	April 2025 Newsletter	Spring updates and development resources
Feb 2025	February 2025 Newsletter	Chapter activities and industry news
Jan 2025	January 2025 Newsletter	New year updates and initiatives

7.4 Website and Contact

- **Website (ongoing efforts from Chapter Resource Committee):** thewiseconnections.github.io
- **Questions:** WISE question form
- **Instagram:** @wiseconnections

- **LinkedIn:** WISE Connections National

8. Keeping This Guide Up to Date

- Send new chapters, officer changes, or social media updates through the question form so the chapter list and website stay current.
- Share your meeting cadence, chapter size, and structure so your chapter can be added to sections 3.3 to 3.5.
- Upload slides from your meetings to the WISE Resource National Bank.